

For the **ELMIRON® Patient Guide**, this page should be simple, reassuring, and action-oriented. Here's a printable version suitable for your website or patient booklet.

Treatment Tips for IC/BPS

Small Changes Can Make a Big Difference

Living with **Interstitial Cystitis/Bladder Pain Syndrome (IC/BPS)** can be challenging, but the right combination of medication, healthy habits, and lifestyle changes can help reduce symptoms and improve your quality of life.

1. Take Your Medication as Prescribed

- Take **ELMIRON®** exactly as directed by your doctor.
- Do not stop treatment without consulting your healthcare provider.
- Improvement may take **3–6 months**, and some patients may need longer to experience the full benefit.
- Continue taking your medication even if you do not notice immediate improvement.

♥ **Patience is important—healing of the bladder lining takes time.**

2. Identify Your Trigger Foods

Some foods and drinks may worsen bladder symptoms.

Common triggers include:

- Coffee and tea
- Carbonated drinks
- Alcohol
- Tomatoes
- Citrus fruits
- Chocolate
- Spicy foods
- Pickles and vinegar

✓ Keep a food diary to identify your personal triggers.

3. Stay Hydrated

- Drink enough water throughout the day.
 - Avoid drinking large amounts at one time.
 - Do not reduce water intake excessively, as concentrated urine may irritate the bladder.
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4. Don't Hold Your Urine

- Empty your bladder regularly.
 - Avoid delaying urination for long periods.
 - Follow your doctor's advice regarding bladder training.
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5. Manage Stress

Stress can trigger or worsen IC/BPS flare-ups.

Try:

- Deep breathing exercises
 - Meditation or mindfulness
 - Yoga
 - Gentle stretching
 - Listening to relaxing music
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6. Stay Physically Active

Regular low-impact exercise may improve overall well-being.

Good options include:

- Walking
- Swimming
- Gentle yoga
- Stretching exercises

Avoid activities that increase pelvic discomfort during flare-ups.

7. Prevent Constipation

Constipation can increase pressure on the bladder and worsen symptoms.

To help prevent constipation:

- Eat fibre-rich foods (if tolerated)
 - Drink adequate water
 - Stay physically active
 - Speak with your doctor if constipation persists
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8. Maintain Good Sleep Habits

Poor sleep may increase pain sensitivity.

Try to:

- Maintain a regular sleep schedule
 - Reduce caffeine, especially in the evening
 - Limit fluid intake 2–3 hours before bedtime if advised by your doctor
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9. Keep a Bladder Diary

Record:

- Fluid intake
- Urination frequency
- Pain levels
- Food triggers
- Flare-ups

This information helps your doctor monitor your progress and adjust treatment if needed.

10. Attend Regular Follow-up Visits

Regular check-ups allow your doctor to:

- Assess your symptoms
 - Monitor treatment response
 - Adjust medications if necessary
 - Address any concerns early
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During an IC/BPS Flare

If your symptoms suddenly worsen:

- ✓ Drink water regularly

- ✓ Avoid known trigger foods
 - ✓ Take your medicines as prescribed
 - ✓ Use relaxation techniques
 - ✓ Rest if needed
 - ✓ Contact your doctor if symptoms are severe or persistent
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Seek Medical Attention Immediately If You Have:

- Fever or chills
 - Blood in urine
 - Severe or worsening pain
 - Inability to pass urine
 - Persistent vomiting
 - New symptoms that concern you
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Remember

IC/BPS is a **chronic condition**, but many people achieve significant symptom relief with the right treatment plan.

Your Treatment Success Depends On:

- ✓ Taking your medication regularly
 - ✓ Following a bladder-friendly diet
 - ✓ Identifying your personal triggers
 - ✓ Maintaining a healthy lifestyle
 - ✓ Working closely with your healthcare provider
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ELMIRON® Patient Reminder

Healing takes time. Stay consistent with your treatment plan, track your symptoms, and maintain regular follow-up with your doctor. Every small step contributes to better bladder health and improved quality of life.

Disclaimer: This guide is for educational purposes only and does not replace medical advice. Always follow the recommendations of your treating physician.